

Answers

Section 1a

Question 1

The old woman was initially by the river edge to wash clothes.

Question 2

- treasure
- remarkable
- marvelled

Question 3

Pupils' own responses, such as: I think the old man and old woman felt proud of their son because the text says they were '**supportive of their son's decision**' and that they '**wished him good luck**'. They also sent him off with his favourite food which shows they encouraged him.

Question 4

Pupils' own responses, such as: The role of the dog was to be ready to support them if there was any trouble or if the ogres were to wake. The role of the monkey was to enter the ogres' land by scaling the wall and opening the door from the inside. The role of the pheasant was to check the area for danger and to signal when the coast was clear.

Question 5

Accept any reasonable answer, as long as a valid reason as to why they feel that their chosen character is the most pivotal to the execution of the plan has been provided.

Question 6

Accept any answer where the student has said that the author wants to depict Momotaro as kind, trusted, brave and intelligent (accept all or a selection of these qualities). Elements from the text to support this opinion include:

- he had a thirst for knowledge
- he wanted to help the village inhabitants recuperate their treasure
- his parents wished him well on his quest and they trusted him
- he willingly gave up some of his food to the animals that asked for it

- he confronted the ogres

Question 7

Accept any answer from the student where they have given a detailed explanation as to how they would change the ending and they have justified their response. Anticipate that students may feel that the ending is a bit weak, that the ogres could fight to keep their treasure and/or that Momotaro and the others 'should' have to work harder to win back the treasure.

Section 1b**Question 1**

- wolfed – devour greedily
- scouted – search or look for
- scaled – climb up a steep surface
- ornate – elaborate or excessive decoration
- inhabitants – residents or occupants

Question 2

Pupils' own responses, such as: The image the author is trying to portray is that the old woman is cutting through the skin of the peach cautiously because it is large and precious and seems different to regular peaches.

Question 3

- grotesque

Question 4

- wringing – squeezing
- miraculous – magical or phenomenal
- sated – quench or satisfy
- enthusiastically – eagerly or keenly
- conceding – admitting that you're wrong or have lost

Question 5

seven

Question 6

Accept any answer where the student references the fact that the ogres' land appears palatial and attractive whereas the ogres themselves are portrayed as ugly beasts. Examples from the text include:

- '...large, ornate gates that guarded the entrance to the ogres' land.'
- a need for the pheasant to have to fly high to see the ogres' land in its entirety
- the fact that the monkey had to scale 'the closest wall' demonstrating that there was more than one
- '...tied thick ropes around each of the beasts.'
- '...thrash as they might'
- '...the grotesque creatures'